Managing Teams

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The Group

- The group is defined as two or more interacting and interdependent individuals who come together to achieve specific goals.

  Groups can be either formal or informal.
- Formal Group: A designated work group defined by an organization's structure. In formal groups, the specific tasks / behaviors that team members should engage in are stipulated by and directed toward organizational goals.
- Informal Group: A group that is neither formally structured nor organizationally determined. These groups are natural formations in the work environment that appear in response to the need for social contact.

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Formal Group

- Command Group: A group composed of individuals who report directly to a given manager.

  Ex: Domain Manager and his or her employees

- Task Group: A group composed of individuals working together to complete a specific job task.

  Ex: Project Manager and Workers

Informal Group

- Interest Group: People working together to attain a specific objective with which each is concerned.

  Ex: Music Band / Dance Group

- Friendship Group: People brought together because they share one or more common characteristics.

  Ex: Sports / Get Together

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Stages of Group Development

- Forming: The first stage in group development, characterized by much uncertainty about group's purpose, structure & leadership. Members 'test the waters' to determine what types of behaviors are acceptable.
- Storming: The second stage in group development, characterized by intragroup conflict. Members accept the existence of the group, but there is resistance to the constraints that the group imposes on individuality. Further, there is conflict over who will control the group.
- Norming: The third stage in group development, characterized by close relationships and cohesiveness. There is a strong sense of group identity & camaraderie.
- Performing: The fourth stage in group development, during which the group is fully functional. Group energy has moved from getting to know & understand each other to performing the task at hand.
- Adjourning: The final stage in group development for temporary groups, characterized by concern with wrapping up activities rather than task performance.

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Group Structure

- Roles: A set of behavior patterns expected of someone occupying a given position in a social unit.
- Norms: Standards or expectations of behavior that are accepted and shared by a group's members.
- Status: A socially defined prestige grading, position or rank with in a group.
- Group Size: The number of individuals participating in the group.
- Group Cohesiveness: The degree to which group members are attracted to one another and share the group's goals.

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Roles

- Role Identity: Certain attitudes and behaviors consistent with a role.
- Role Perception: An individual's view of how he or she is supposed to act in a given situation.
- Role Expectations: How others believe a person should act in a given situation.
- Psychological Contract: An unwritten agreement that sets out what management expects from an employee and vice versa.
- Role Conflict: A situation in which an individual is confronted by divergent role expectations.

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Norms

- Acceptable standards / expectations of behavior that are shared by the group's members.
- Tells what is expected of you under certain situations.
- Acts as a means of influencing the behavior of the group members with minimal external controls.

They are different kinds of norms:

- Performance Norms
- Appearance Norms
- Social Arrangement Norms
- Resource Allocation Norms

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Norms

- Reference Groups: Important groups to which individuals belong or hope to belong and with whose norms individuals are likely to conform.
- Conformity: The adjustment of one's behavior to align with the norms of the group.
- Groupthink: A phenomenon in which a group exerts extensive pressure on an individual to align his or her opinion with others' opinions.
- Deviant Workplace Behavior: Voluntary behavior that violates significant organizational norms and, in so doing, threatens the well being of the organization or its members. Also called antisocial behavior or workplace incivility.

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Typology of Deviant Workplace Behavior

- Production: Leaving early, intentionally working slowly, wasting resources.
- Property: Sabotage, Lying about hours worked, stealing from the organization.
- Political: Showing favoritism, gossiping & spreading rumors, blaming coworkers.
- Personal Aggression: Sexual harassment, verbal abuse, stealing from coworkers.

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Status

- Status Characteristics Theory: A theory that states that differences in status characteristics create status hierarchies within groups.

  Status is determined by:

1. The power a person wields over others.
2. A person's ability to contribute to a group's goals.
3. An individual's personal characteristics.

Group Size

- Social Loafing: The tendency for individuals to expend less effort when working collectively than when working individually.

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Group Cohesiveness

- Relationship of group cohesiveness & performance norms with productivity.
- Signifies the importance of performance norms.

		Cohesiveness	
		High	Low
Performance Norms	High	Increase in Productivity	Moderate Increase in Productivity
	Low	Decrease in Productivity	No Effect on Productivity

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Group Processes - Group Decision Making

- Interacting Groups: Typical groups in which members interact with each other face to face.
- Brainstorming: An idea generation process that specifically encourages any and all alternatives while withholding any criticism of those alternatives.
- Nominal Group Technique: A group decision making method in which individual members meet face to face to pool their judgments in a systematic but independent fashion.
- Electronic Meeting: A meeting in which members interact on computers, allowing for anonymity of comments and aggregation of votes.

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Group Decision Making

Strengths

- More complete information & knowledge
- Increased diversity of views
- Acceptance of a solution

Weakness

- Conformity pressures in groups
- Dominated by one or a few members
- Ambiguous responsibility

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Group Processes - Conflict Management

- Conflict: A process that begins when one party perceives that another party has negatively affected, or is about to negatively affect, something that the first party cares about.
- Traditional View of Conflict: The belief that all conflict is harmful and must be avoided.
- Human Relations View of Conflict: The belief that conflict is a natural and inevitable outcome in any group.
- Interactionist View of Conflict: The belief that conflict is not only a positive force in a group but that it is also an absolute necessity for a group to perform effectively.

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Interactionist View of Conflict

- Functional Conflict - FC (Constructive): Conflict that supports the goals of the group and improves its performance.
- Dysfunctional Conflict - DFC (Destructive): Conflict that hinders group performance.

Types of Conflict

- Task Conflict: Conflict over content and goals of the work (May be a FC).
- Relationship Conflict: Conflict based on interpersonal relationships (Mostly a DFC).
- Process Conflict: Conflict over how work gets done (May be a FC).

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Conflict Management Options

- Competing: A desire to satisfy one's interests, regardless of the impact on the other party to the conflict.
- Collaborating: A situation in which the parties to a conflict each desire to satisfy fully concerns of all parties.
- Avoiding: The desire to withdraw from or suppress a conflict.
- Accommodating: The willingness of one party in a conflict to place the opponent's interests above his or her own.
- Compromising: A situation in which each party to a conflict is willing to give up something.

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Conflict Management Options

- Competing / Forcing: High Assertiveness & Low Cooperativeness
- Collaborating: High Assertiveness & High Cooperativeness
- Avoiding: Low Assertiveness & Low Cooperativeness
- Accommodating: Low Assertiveness & High Cooperativeness
- Compromising: Moderate Assertiveness & Moderate Cooperativeness

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Work Team

- A team is a group of individuals, all working together for a common purpose.
- They should all work together and strive towards the achievement of a common goal.
- Individuals who are not compatible with each other can never form a team.
- The team members must complement each other and work in unison.
- Personal interests must take a back seat and all of them must deliver their level best to achieve the team objective.

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Types of Work Teams

- **Problem Solving Team**
- A team from the same department or functional area that's involved in efforts to improve work activities or to solve pecific problems.
- **Self Managed Team**
- A type of work team that operates without a manager and is responsible for a complete work process or segment.
- **Cross Functional Team**
- A work team composed of individuals from various specialties.
- **Virtual Team**
- A type of work team that uses technology to link phisically dispersed memebers in order to achieve a common goal.

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Creating Effective Work Teams

- Clear Goals
- Relevant Skills
- Mutual Trust
- Unified Commitment
- Good Communication
- Negotiating Skills
- Appropriate Leadership
- Internal & External Support

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